

Persist Week of April 27, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at support@functional-bodybuilding.com

We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.

This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at <https://functional-bodybuilding.com> if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x

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Pump Lift 5x

Monday, April 27th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Volume and Intensity Progression

Over this six-week progression, reps gradually decrease while weights increase. Some athletes feel more fatigued by higher reps, while others feel it more from heavier loading, so pay attention to how the later weeks affect your body. You might feel energized by fewer reps and heavier weights, or you may notice more fatigue. Neither is right nor wrong – the goal is simply to build awareness of how you respond to different training stress. When the next training block begins, and you return to Week 1, the relationship flips again, bringing you back to higher reps and lighter loads to restart the progression.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Split Stance Isometric w/ Pulse; 20-30 sec/side

Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 minutes)

Cyclist Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

3 sets; rest 60sec between sides

Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for an RPE of 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remaining two sets.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

Plate Loaded Heel Elevated Pistol Squat; 4-6 reps/side @ 30X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Plate Loaded Banded Spanish Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

Side Plank Rotations; 20-30 sec/side

rest 30 sec

Weighted Anchored Sit Up; 10-15 reps

rest 60 sec and back to 1.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec

Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec

Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, April 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Deficit Pushup

If you're completing the deficit pushups comfortably within the prescribed rep range, here are a few ways to increase the challenge without adding weight: Slow the lowering phase even more. Add a pause at the top or bottom of each rep. Focus on increasing muscle tension throughout the

movement—actively squeeze the pecs at the top and maintain tension through the pecs and triceps as you lower. Small adjustments in control can dramatically increase the stimulus.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side

Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Push Press

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

Low Incline DB Bench Press

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 9 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 7 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

Deficit Pushup; 12-15 @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Dumbbell Full Raise; 12-15 @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2 sets

Flat Bench Fly Press; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Narrow Grip DB Bench Press; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Diamond Plank; 30 sec

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side

Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side

Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, April 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Farmers Walk For Hypertrophy

The farmer's walk is an underrated tool for building muscle. One key to hypertrophy is loading muscles in a lengthened position, and the carry places the upper traps under a long, sustained stretch as they work to stabilize the load. That prolonged tension can create a strong growth stimulus for the traps. If your goal is to emphasize trap development, consider using lifting straps. Reducing grip limitation allows the traps to fatigue more fully and keeps the focus where we want it.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

3 Sets

Mixed Front Rack Overhead Carry; 30m/side; 15m/side

Renegade Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12-15 min):

Close Grip Lat Pulldown or Neutral Grip Pull Up

Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Double Drop Set to Failure.

Loading Note:

If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the double drop set, don't worry about percentages; instead, add back two levels of assistance (or less weight), similar to your first and second working sets. You will adjust the weight again for your second drop set. Drop sets are performed right after you have adjusted the weight after your set of 4.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Barbell Bent Over Row

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Gorilla Dumbbell Elbowing Row; 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Farmers Walk; 30m

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Towel KB Curl; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

directly into

Towel KB Bicep Carry; 20-30 sec

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Bottom of Bench Dip Stretch; 30 sec
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation w/ Reach; 5/side
Tall Kneeling Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work :

A) Active Recovery (40 min)
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 8
4 Sets
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10/arm
15sec Single Leg Wall Sit/leg
15sec Planche Lean
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 8
4 Sets
15sec Single Arm Reverse Plank Bridge R
15sec Single Arm Reverse Plank Bridge L
15sec Star Plank R
15sec Star Plank L
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 8

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):

30 min Mobility
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Circles x 10
Downdog to Updog x 5
Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 with 5 sec hold.
Prone Band Pass Through x 10
Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10
Crab Reach x 5/side

Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side
Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 1 min Center
Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min
Reverse Nordics x 10

Friday, May 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Romanian Deadlift Low Rep

Five reps on the Romanian deadlift is relatively low for this movement. The heavier loading helps reinforce strong bracing mechanics and creates a powerful posterior chain stimulus. Because of that demand, execution matters. This week the reps decrease, but the tempo slows, increasing the difficulty of each rep. If you're newer to RDLs, keep the load modest – either stay at last week's weight or increase by about 5% to account for the slower tempo. Move well first, then load it.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side

Barbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Romanian Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

Front Rack Split Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @30X0
rest 60 sec

L Sit on Parallettes; 15-30 sec
rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

Knees Over Toes Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-15 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec

Lateral Banded Walk; 10-15 reps/side
rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note;

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side

Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, May 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Back Supported Arnold Press

The back-supported vertical press is a great option if overhead mobility is limited. The support allows a slight lean back so you can press overhead without excessive stress on the lower back. Use the support to your advantage, but avoid turning it into an incline press. Keep the movement as vertical as possible while staying controlled.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec cardio of choice

Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side

Prone Snow Angels; 10 reps

Band Pullapart; 15 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Barbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Back Supported Single Arm Arnold Press

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Landmine Meadow Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Single Arm DB or Cable Lean Away Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warm-up set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 Min):

2-3 sets

Dual KB Front Rack Carry; 40m

rest 15 sec

Ring or Plank Body Saw; 30 sec

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be challenging and fatiguing for the upper body.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Sunday, May 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Work in Lesson - Week 6

Equipment won't replace effort, but the right tools can help you get more out of the effort you're already giving.

Straps can let you train your posterior chain without your grip giving out first. Stable shoes can make heavy lifts feel more grounded and controlled. A belt can help you brace better when the load gets serious. None of that is cheating - it's just using tools to support the work.

These aren't shortcuts; they're leverage. And if something helps you train harder, safer, and more consistently, I'm all for it - as long as you're using it with intention and not as a crutch.

That said, the most important accessory you own isn't something you buy. It's consistency.

With love,

Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, April 27th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Volume and Intensity Progression

Over this six-week progression, reps gradually decrease while weights increase. Some athletes feel more fatigued by higher reps, while others feel it more from heavier loading, so pay attention to how the later weeks affect your body. You might feel energized by fewer reps and heavier weights, or you may notice more fatigue. Neither is right nor wrong – the goal is simply to build awareness of how you respond to different training stress. When the next training block begins, and you return to Week 1, the relationship flips again, bringing you back to higher reps and lighter loads to restart the progression.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Split Stance Isometric w/ Pulse; 20-30 sec/side

Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 minutes):

Cyclist Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

3 sets; rest 60sec between sides

Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for an RPE of 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remaining two sets.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

Plate Loaded Heel Elevated Pistol Squat; 4-6 reps/side @ 30X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Plate Loaded Banded Spanish Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

Side Plank Rotations; 20-30 sec/side

rest 30 sec

Weighted Anchored Sit Up; 10-15 reps

rest 60 sec and back to 1.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec

Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec

Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, April 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Deficit Pushup

If you're completing the deficit pushups comfortably within the prescribed rep range, here are a few ways to increase the challenge without adding weight: Slow the lowering phase even more. Add a pause at the top or bottom of each rep. Focus on increasing muscle tension throughout the movement—actively squeeze the pecs at the top and maintain tension through the pecs and triceps as you lower. Small adjustments in control can dramatically increase the stimulus.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side

Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Push Press

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Barbell Bent Over Row

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

Deficit Pushup; 12-15 @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Dumbbell Full Raise; 12-15 @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Towel KB Curl; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

Directly into

Towel KB Bicep Carry; 20-30 sec

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Bottom of Bench Dip Stretch; 30 sec

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation w/ Reach; 5/side

Tall Kneeling Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, April 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):

30 min Mobility

Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min

Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min

Wrist Circles x 10

Downdog to Updog x 5

Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 with 5 sec hold.

Prone Band Pass Through x 10

Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10

Crab Reach x 5/side

Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side

Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 1 min Center

Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min

Reverse Nordics x 10

Thursday, April 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Romanian Deadlift Low Rep

Five reps on the Romanian deadlift is relatively low for this movement. The heavier loading helps reinforce strong bracing mechanics and creates a powerful posterior chain stimulus. Because of that demand, execution matters. This week, the reps decrease, but the tempo slows, increasing the difficulty of each rep. If you're newer to RDLs, keep the load modest – either stay at last week's weight or increase by about 5% to account for the slower tempo. Move well first, then load it.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side

Barbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Romanian Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

Front Rack Split Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 Min):

3 sets

Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0

rest 60 sec

L Sit on Parallettes; 15-30 sec

rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

Knees Over Toes Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-15 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Lateral Banded Walk; 10-15 reps/side

rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side

Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, May 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

More Upper Back

The upper back handles fatigue well, which means it can be trained frequently throughout the week. In the strength balance section, you'll see additional rowing variations for that reason.

Beyond building strength, consistent upper back work also helps support balance around the shoulder and improves overall pressing mechanics.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec cardio of choice

Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side

Prone Snow Angels; 10 reps

Band Pullapart; 15 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):

Close Grip Lat Pulldown or Neutral Grip Pull Up

Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 4 @20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Double Drop Set to Failure.

Loading Note:

If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the double drop set, don't worry about percentages; instead, add back two levels of assistance (or less weight), similar to your first and second working sets. You will adjust the weight again for your second drop set. Drop sets are performed immediately after you adjust the weight after your set of 4.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):

Barbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Gorilla DB Elbowing Row; 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Farmers Walk; 30m

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2 sets

Flat Bench Fly Press; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Narrow Grip DB Bench Press; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Diamond Plank; 30 sec

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Hands Clapsed Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, May 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30-35 min):

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run, Row, or Bike

1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%

2mins @ 90%

1:30 @ 80%

1min @ 70%

EMOM x 6mins

Odd - 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side

Even - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Hold

Run, Row, or Bike

1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%

2mins @ 90%

1:30 @ 80%

1min @ 70%

EMOM x 6mins

Odd - 20-30sec Half Push Up Isometric

Even - 20sec Chin Over Bar Isometric

Run, Row or Bike

1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%

2mins @ 90%

1:30 @ 80%

1min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (15 min):

Upper Body Mobility

Shoulder Circles

Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side

Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side

Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side

Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side

Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold

Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Downdog to Updog x 5

Sunday, May 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Work in Lesson - Week 6

Equipment won't replace effort, but the right tools can help you get more out of the effort you're already giving.

Straps can let you train your posterior chain without your grip giving out first. Stable shoes can make heavy lifts feel more grounded and controlled. A belt can help you brace better when the load gets serious. None of that is cheating - it's just using tools to support the work.

These aren't shortcuts; they're leverage. And if something helps you train harder, safer, and more consistently, I'm all for it - as long as you're using it with intention and not as a crutch.

That said, the most important accessory you own isn't something you buy. It's consistency.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, April 27th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Deficit Pushup

If you're completing the deficit pushups comfortably within the prescribed rep range, here are a few ways to increase the challenge without adding weight: Slow the lowering phase even more. Add a pause at the top or bottom of each rep. Focus on increasing muscle tension throughout the movement—actively squeeze the pecs at the top and maintain tension through the pecs and triceps as you lower. Small adjustments in control can dramatically increase the stimulus.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Split Stance Isometric w/ Pulse; 20-30 sec/side

Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1(15 minutes):

Cyclist Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2(12 min):

Close Grip Lat Pulldown or Neutral Grip Pull Up

Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 4 @20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Double Drop Set to Failure.

Loading Note:

If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the double drop set, don't worry about percentages; instead, add back two levels of assistance (or less weight), similar to your first and second working sets. You will adjust the weight again for your second drop set. Drop sets are performed immediately after you adjust the weight after your set of 4.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

Deficit Pushup; 12-15 @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Dumbbell Full Raise; 12-15 @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

Side Plank Rotations; 20-30 sec/side

rest 30 sec

Weighted Anchored Sit Up; 10-15 reps

rest 60 sec and back to 1.

Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 6-8 reps/side

Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec

Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, April 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):

30 min Full Body Mobility

Neck Cars x 3/side

Segmented Cat/Cow x 5-10

Passive Hang x 1 min

Banded Shoulder Extension x 10

Banded Shoulder Extension x 10

Shoulder Circles x 5/side

Wrist Stretch Extension Stretch + Wrist Isometrics

Bretzel Stretch

Lumbar Roll to Pike

Lumbar Roll to Pancake

Pancake 3 way 1 min each direction

Cobra 5 x 5 sec

Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side

Wednesday, April 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Push Press Technique

The push press is an explosive overhead lift that allows for an over-loaded weight by nature of using the legs to assist the press during the hardest portion. Make sure to control the lockout and descent to get the most out of this lift.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side

Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Push Press

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Barbell Bent Over Row

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 Min):

3 sets

Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0

rest 60 sec

L Sit on Parallettes; 15-30 sec

rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Towel KB Curl; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
directly into

Towel KB Bicep Carry; 20-30 sec
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Bottom of Bench Dip Stretch; 30 sec
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation w/ Reach; 5/side

Tall Kneeling Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

April 30th, 2026

Thursday, April 30th, 2026

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:

Shoulder Extension

Passive Hang x 1 min

Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min

Banded Shoulder Extension x 10

Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold

Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side

PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Friday, May 1st, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:

Romanian Deadlift Low Rep

Five reps on the Romanian deadlift is relatively low for this movement. The heavier loading helps reinforce strong bracing mechanics and creates a powerful posterior chain stimulus. Because of that demand, execution matters. This week, the reps decrease, but the tempo slows, increasing the difficulty of each rep. If you're newer to RDLs, keep the load modest – either stay at last week's weight or increase by about 5% to account for the slower tempo. Move well first, then load it.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side

Barbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Romanian Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):

Barbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

Plate Loaded Heel Elevated Pistol Squat; 4-6 reps/side @ 30X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Plate Loaded Banded Spanish Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

Dual KB Front Rack Carry; 40m

rest 15 sec

Ring or Plank Body Saw; 30 sec

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be challenging and fatiguing for the upper body.

Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side

Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, May 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30-35 min):

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run, Row, or Bike

1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%

2mins @ 90%

1:30 @ 80%

1min @ 70%

EMOM x 6mins

Odd - 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
Even - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Hold
Run, Row, or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20-30sec Half Push Up Isometric
Even - 20sec Chin Over Bar Isometric
Run, Row, or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (15 min):

Upper Body Mobility
Shoulder Circles
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Downdog to Updog x 5

Sunday, May 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x
Work in Lesson - Week 6

Equipment won't replace effort, but the right tools can help you get more out of the effort you're already giving.

Straps can let you train your posterior chain without your grip giving out first. Stable shoes can make heavy lifts feel more grounded and controlled. A belt can help you brace better when the load gets serious. None of that is cheating - it's just using tools to support the work.

These aren't shortcuts; they're leverage. And if something helps you train harder, safer, and more consistently, I'm all for it - as long as you're using it with intention and not as a crutch.

That said, the most important accessory you own isn't something you buy. It's consistency.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Monday, April 27th, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:

Volume and Intensity Progression

Over this six-week progression, reps gradually decrease while weights increase. Some athletes feel more fatigued by higher reps, while others feel it more from heavier loading, so pay attention to how the later weeks affect your body. You might feel energized by fewer reps and heavier weights, or you may notice more fatigue. Neither is right nor wrong – the goal is simply to build awareness of how you respond to different training stress. When the next training block begins, and you return to Week 1, the relationship flips again, bringing you back to higher reps and lighter loads to restart the progression.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

:

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Split Stance Isometric w/ Pulse; 20-30 sec/side

Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):

Cyclist Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

Plate Loaded Heel Elevated Pistol Squat; 4-6 reps/side @ 30X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Plate Loaded Banded Spanish Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):

Every 3:00 x 5 Sets

Row 15/12 Calories (Male/Female)

14 Weight Plate Turkish Sit Ups 25/10lb#

14 Hamstring March (7/side) 50/35lb#

Effort Note:

Every 3 minutes, begin a new set. Complete all three movements in the listed order within the 3-minute window. This is performed as a sequence, not separate intervals. Aim to finish the work with approximately 30 seconds remaining in each 3-minute block so you can rest before the next set begins. Adjust your pace as needed to maintain consistent effort across all 5 sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec

Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec

Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Tuesday, April 28th, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:

Deficit Pushup

If you're completing the deficit pushups comfortably within the prescribed rep range, here are a few ways to increase the challenge without adding weight: Slow the lowering phase even more. Add a pause at the top or bottom of each rep. Focus on increasing muscle tension throughout the movement—actively squeeze the pecs at the top and maintain tension through the pecs and triceps as you lower. Small adjustments in control can dramatically increase the stimulus.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side

Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Push Press

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

Deficit Pushup; 12-15 @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Dumbbell Full Raise; 12-15 @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (15 min):

2 Sets

For Time

500/400m Row @ 85% (Male/Female)

-60sec rest-

3 rounds for time:

12 Dumbbell Bench Press 50/35#

40 Double Unders or 60 Single Unders

-90-second rest and then repeat from the beginning for a second set-

Effort Note:

For each set (there are 2), complete the 500m Row, then take a 60-second rest, then complete 3 rounds of the couplet. Upon completion of your 3rd round of the couplet, rest 90 seconds and then go back to the Row for the second set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side

Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side

Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Wednesday, April 29th, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:

Farmers Walk For Hypertrophy

The farmer's walk is an underrated tool for building muscle. One key to hypertrophy is loading muscles in a lengthened position, and the carry places the upper traps under a long, sustained stretch as they work to stabilize the load. That prolonged tension can create a strong growth stimulus for the traps. If your goal is to emphasize trap development, consider using lifting straps. Reducing grip limitation allows the traps to fatigue more fully and keeps the focus where we want it.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

3 Sets

Mixed Front Rack Overhead Carry; 30m/side; 15m/side

Renegade Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):

Close Grip Lat Pulldown or Neutral Grip Pull Up

Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Double Drop Set to Failure.

Loading Note:

If using pullups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the double drop set, don't worry about percentages; instead, add back two levels of assistance (or less weight), similar to your first and second working sets. You will adjust the weight again for your second drop set. Drop sets are performed right after you have adjusted the weight after your set of 4.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 Min):

3 sets

Wide Grip Barbell Bent Over Row; 8-10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Farmers Walk; 30m

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) High Turnover Cardio (12 min):

12mins Continuous Effort

2-4-6-8-10-12...

Chainsaw Row Right Arm 70/50# (Male/Female)

Chainsaw Row Left Arm 70/50#

Burpee Over DB

*6/5 Calorie Bike Between Sets

Effort Note:

Ascend as far as you can in the single arm row and burpee, performing the Bike between each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Bottom of Bench Dip Stretch; 30 sec

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation w/ Reach; 5/side

Tall Kneeling Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Thursday, April 30th, 2026

A) Active Recovery Work :

A) Active Recovery (40 min)

Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate

Walk 30sec

x 8

4 Sets

Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10/arm

15sec Single Leg Wall Sit/leg

15sec Planche Lean

Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate

Walk 30sec

x 8

4 Sets

15sec Single Arm Reverse Plank Bridge R

15sec Single Arm Reverse Plank Bridge L

15sec Star Plank R

15sec Star Plank L

Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate

Walk 30sec

x 8

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):

30 min Mobility

Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min

Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min

Wrist Circles x 10

Downdog to Updog x 5

Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 with 5 sec hold.

Prone Band Pass Through x 10

Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10

Crab Reach x 5/side

Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side

Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 1 min Center

Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min

Reverse Nordics x 10

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Friday, May 1st, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:

Romanian Deadlift Low Rep

Five reps on the Romanian deadlift is relatively low for this movement. The heavier loading helps reinforce strong bracing mechanics and creates a powerful posterior chain stimulus. Because of that demand, execution matters. This week, reps decrease, but tempo slows, making each rep more difficult. If you're newer to RDLs, keep the load modest – either stay at last week's weight or increase by about 5% to account for the slower tempo. Move well first, then load it.

Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side

Barbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Romanian Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

L Sit on Parallettes; 15-30 sec

rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (12-15 min):

3 Sets

Run 200m

rest 15sec

16 DB Suitcase Walking Lunge 50/35#

12 Squat Jumps

rest 15sec

Run 200m

rest walk 60-90sec between sets

Effort Note:

Set 1 - Moderate Pace

Set 2 - Hard Pace

Set 3 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side

Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Friday, May 2nd, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:

Landmine Meadow Row Technique

The landmine meadows row is a single-arm row variation that uses the landmine setup to challenge the upper back, lats, and rear delts from a different angle.

Use a wider elbow path and focus on pulling through the back rather than the arm. The leverage of the landmine helps create a strong contraction while keeping tension consistent throughout the rep.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec cardio of choice

Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
Prone Snow Angels; 10 reps
Band Pullapart; 15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Barbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Landmine Meadow Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Single Arm DB or Cable Lean Away Lateral Raise;; 12-15 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):

Every 90sec x 8 sets

1st Set- 8-10 Burpee to Plate + 4-8 Supinated Strict Pull Up @ 30X0 Tempo

2nd Set - 8-10 Burpee to Plate + 6-8 Alternating KB Push Press 35/26# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

*Every 90 sec you begin a new set, and it starts with the 1st, then moves to the 2nd. Your 3rd set is a repeat of the 1st.

*Pull Ups - Scale your pull ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Hands Clapsed Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Sunday, May 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Work in Lesson - Week 6

Equipment won't replace effort, but the right tools can help you get more out of the effort you're already giving.

Straps can let you train your posterior chain without your grip giving out first. Stable shoes can make heavy lifts feel more grounded and controlled. A belt can help you brace better when the load gets serious. None of that is cheating - it's just using tools to support the work.

These aren't shortcuts; they're leverage. And if something helps you train harder, safer, and more consistently, I'm all for it - as long as you're using it with intention and not as a crutch.

That said, the most important accessory you own isn't something you buy. It's consistency.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, April 27th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Volume and Intensity Progression

Over this six-week progression, reps gradually decrease while weights increase. Some athletes feel more fatigued by higher reps, while others feel it more from heavier loading, so pay attention to how the later weeks affect your body. You might feel energized by fewer reps and heavier weights, or you may notice more fatigue. Neither is right nor wrong – the goal is simply to build awareness of how you respond to different training stress. When the next training block begins, and you return to Week 1, the relationship flips again, bringing you back to higher reps and lighter loads to restart the progression.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Split Stance Isometric w/ Pulse; 20-30 sec/side

Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):

Cyclist Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

Plate Loaded Heel Elevated Pistol Squat; 4-6 reps/side @ 30X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Plate Loaded Banded Spanish Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):

Every 3:00 x 5 Sets

Row 15/12 Calories (Male/Female)

14 Weight Plate Turkish Sit Ups 25/10#

14 Hamstring March (7/side) 50/35#

Effort Note:

Every 3 minutes, begin a new set. Complete all three movements in the listed order within the 3-minute window. This is performed as a sequence, not separate intervals. Aim to finish the work with approximately 30 seconds remaining in each 3-minute block so you can rest before the next set begins. Adjust your pace as needed to maintain consistent effort across all 5 sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec

Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, April 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Farmers Walk For Hypertrophy

The farmer's walk is an underrated tool for building muscle. One key to hypertrophy is loading muscles in a lengthened position, and the carry places the upper traps under a long, sustained stretch as they work to stabilize the load. That prolonged tension can create a strong growth stimulus for the traps. If your goal is to emphasize trap development, consider using lifting straps. Reducing grip limitation allows the traps to fatigue more fully and keeps the focus where we want it.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side

Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Close Grip Lat Pulldown or Neutral Grip Pull Up

Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Double Drop Set to Failure.

Loading Note:

If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the double drop set, don't worry about percentages; instead, add back two levels of assistance (or less weight), similar to your first and second working sets. You will adjust the weight again for your second drop set. Drop sets are performed right after you have adjusted the weight after your set of 4.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets:

Wide Grip Barbell Bent Over Row; 8-10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Farmers Walk; 30m

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (14 min):

Every 2 minutes x 3 Sets

12/10 Cal Row @ High Effort (Male/Female)

15-20 Pushups

Rest 2 minutes

Every 2 minutes x 3 Sets

12/10 Cal Row @ High Effort

KB Goblet Carry 40m 53/35#

Effort Note:

Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set. Take 2 minutes' rest after the first 3 sets. Push the pace on these intervals.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side

Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side

Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, April 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):

30 min Mobility

Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min

Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min

Wrist Circles x 10

Downdog to Updog x 5
Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 with 5 sec hold.
Prone Band Pass Through x 10
Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10
Crab Reach x 5/side
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side
Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 1 min Center
Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min
Reverse Nordics x 10

Thursday, April 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Romanian Deadlift Low Rep

Five reps on the Romanian deadlift is relatively low for this movement. The heavier loading helps reinforce strong bracing mechanics and creates a powerful posterior chain stimulus. Because of that demand, execution matters. This week, reps decrease, but tempo slows, making each rep more difficult. If you're newer to RDLs, keep the load modest – either stay at last week's weight or increase by about 5% to account for the slower tempo. Move well first, then load it.

Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side

Barbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Romanian Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

L Sit on Parallettes; 15-30 sec

rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (12-15 min):

3 Sets

Run 200m

rest 15sec

16 DB Suitcase Walking Lunge 50/35#

12 Squat Jumps

rest 15sec

Run 200m

rest walk 60-90sec between sets

Effort Note:

Set 1 - Moderate Pace

Set 2 - Hard Pace

Set 3 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side

Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, May 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Landmine Meadow Row Technique

The landmine meadows row is a single-arm row variation that uses the landmine setup to challenge the upper back, lats, and rear delts from a different angle.

Use a wider elbow path and focus on pulling through the back rather than the arm. The leverage of the landmine helps create a strong contraction while keeping tension consistent throughout the rep.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec cardio of choice

Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side

Prone Snow Angels; 10 reps

Band Pullapart; 15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Barbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Landmine Meadow Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Single Arm DB or Cable Lean Away Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):

Every 90sec x 8 sets

1st Set- 8-10 Burpee to Plate + 4-8 Supinated Strict Pull Up @ 30X0 Tempo

2nd Set - 8-10 Burpee to Plate + 6-8 Alternating KB Push Press 35/26# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

*Every 90 sec you begin a new set, and it starts with the 1st, then moves to the 2nd. Your 3rd set is a repeat of the 1st.

*Pull Ups - Scale your pull ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Hands Clapsed Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, May 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30-35 min):

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run, Row, or Bike

1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%

2mins @ 90%

1:30 @ 80%

1min @ 70%

EMOM x 6mins

Odd - 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side

Even - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Hold

Run, Row, or Bike

1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%

2mins @ 90%

1:30 @ 80%

1min @ 70%

EMOM x 6mins

Odd - 20-30sec Half Push Up Isometric

Even - 20sec Chin Over Bar Isometric

Run, Row, or Bike

1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%

2mins @ 90%

1:30 @ 80%

1min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (15 min):

Upper Body Mobility

Shoulder Circles

Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side

Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side

Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side

Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side

Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold

Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold

Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold

Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps

Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min

Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min

Downdog to Updog x 5

Sunday, May 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

Work in Lesson - Week 6

Equipment won't replace effort, but the right tools can help you get more out of the effort you're already giving.

Straps can let you train your posterior chain without your grip giving out first. Stable shoes can make heavy lifts feel more grounded and controlled. A belt can help you brace better when the load gets serious. None of that is cheating - it's just using tools to support the work.

These aren't shortcuts; they're leverage. And if something helps you train harder, safer, and more consistently, I'm all for it - as long as you're using it with intention and not as a crutch.

That said, the most important accessory you own isn't something you buy. It's consistency.

With love,

Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, April 27th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Volume and Intensity Progression

Over this six-week progression, reps gradually decrease while weights increase. Some athletes feel more fatigued by higher reps, while others feel it more from heavier loading, so pay attention to how the later weeks affect your body. You might feel energized by fewer reps and heavier weights, or you may notice more fatigue. Neither is right nor wrong – the goal is simply to build awareness of how you respond to different training stress. When the next training block begins, and you return to Week 1, the relationship flips again, bringing you back to higher reps and lighter loads to restart the progression.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Split Stance Isometric w/ Pulse; 20-30 sec/side

Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):

Cyclist Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

Deficit Pushup; 12-15 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Dumbbell Full Raise; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):

Every 3:00 x 5 Sets

Row 15/12 Calories (Male/Female)

14 Weight Plate Turkish Sit Ups 25/10#

14 Hamstring March (7/side) 50/35#

Effort Note:

Every 3 minutes, begin a new set. Complete all three movements in the listed order within the 3-minute window. This is performed as a sequence, not separate intervals. Aim to finish the work with approximately 30 seconds remaining in each 3-minute block so you can rest before the next set begins. Adjust your pace as needed to maintain consistent effort across all 5 sets

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 6-8 reps/side

Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec

Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, April 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):

30 min Full Body Mobility

Neck Cars x 3/side

Segmented Cat/Cow x 5-10

Passive Hang x 1 min

Banded Shoulder Extension x 10

Banded Shoulder Extension x 10

Shoulder Circles x 5/side

Wrist Stretch Extension Stretch + Wrist Isometrics

Bretzel Stretch

Lumbar Roll to Pike

Lumbar Roll to Pancake

Pancake 3 way Stretch 1 min each direction
Cobra 5 x 5 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side

Wednesday, April 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Farmers Walk For Hypertrophy

The farmer's walk is an underrated tool for building muscle. One key to hypertrophy is loading muscles in a lengthened position, and the carry places the upper traps under a long, sustained stretch as they work to stabilize the load. That prolonged tension can create a strong growth stimulus for the traps. If your goal is to emphasize trap development, consider using lifting straps. Reducing grip limitation allows the traps to fatigue more fully and keeps the focus where we want it.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side

Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Push Press

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

Wide Grip Barbell Bent Over Row; 8-10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Farmers Walk; 30m

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (12-15 min):

3 Sets

Run 200m

rest 15sec

16 DB Suitcase Walking Lunge 50/35#

12 Squat Jumps

rest 15sec

Run 200m

rest walk 60-90sec between sets

Effort Note:

Set 1 - Moderate Pace

Set 2 - Hard Pace

Set 3 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Bottom of Bench Dip Stretch; 30 sec

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation w/ Reach; 5/side

Tall Kneeling Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Shoulder Extension

Passive Hang x 1 min

Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min

Banded Shoulder Extension x 10

Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold

Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side

PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10

Friday, May 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Romanian Deadlift Low Rep

Five reps on the Romanian deadlift is relatively low for this movement. The heavier loading helps reinforce strong bracing mechanics and creates a powerful posterior chain stimulus. Because of that demand, execution matters. This week, reps decrease, but tempo slows, making each rep more difficult. If you're newer to RDLs, keep the load modest – either stay at last week's weight or increase by about 5% to account for the slower tempo. Move well first, then load it.

Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side

Barbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Romanian Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Landmine Meadow Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Single Arm DB or Cable Lean Away Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets:

Every 2 minutes x 3 Sets

12/10 Cal Row @ High Effort (Male/Female)

15-20 Pushups

Rest 2 minutes

Every 2 minutes x 3 Sets

12/10 Cal Row @ High Effort

KB Goblet Carry 40m 53/35#

Effort Note:

Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set. Take 2 minutes' rest after the first 3 sets. Push the pace on these intervals.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side

Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, May 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30-35 min) :

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run, Row, or Bike

1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%

2mins @ 90%

1:30 @ 80%

1min @ 70%

EMOM x 6mins

Odd - 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side

Even - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Hold

Run, Row, or Bike

1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%

2mins @ 90%

1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20-30sec Half Push Up Isometric
Even - 20sec Chin Over Bar Isometric
Run, Row, or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (15 min):

Upper Body Mobility
Shoulder Circles 5 reps/side
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Downdog to Updog x 5

Sunday, May 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

Work in Lesson - Week 6

Equipment won't replace effort, but the right tools can help you get more out of the effort you're already giving.

Straps can let you train your posterior chain without your grip giving out first. Stable shoes can make heavy lifts feel more grounded and controlled. A belt can help you brace better when the load gets serious. None of that is cheating - it's just using tools to support the work.

These aren't shortcuts; they're leverage. And if something helps you train harder, safer, and more consistently, I'm all for it - as long as you're using it with intention and not as a crutch.

That said, the most important accessory you own isn't something you buy. It's consistency.

With love,
Marcus

Perform

Monday, April 27th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:

Volume and Intensity Progression

Over this six-week progression, reps gradually decrease while weights increase. Some athletes feel more fatigued by higher reps, while others feel it more from heavier loading, so pay attention to how the later weeks affect your body. You might feel energized by fewer reps and heavier weights, or you may notice more fatigue. Neither is right nor wrong – the goal is simply to build awareness of how you respond to different training stress. When the next training block begins, and you return to Week 1, the relationship flips again, bringing you back to higher reps and lighter loads to restart the progression.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

1) 90 sec Cardio of Choice

2) Split Stance Isometric w/Pulse; 20-30 sec/side

3) Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15min):

1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)

10 Romanian Deadlift

10 Strict Press

10 Front Squat

10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold

10 sec Front Rack Hold

10 sec Front Squat Hold

+

4-5 sets; rest 90-120sec between sets

1 Power Clean + 2 Box Jump Over Clear the Box

Sets 1-2: Easy

Set 3-4: Moderate

Set 5: Challenging

*Aim for max power on the jump every rep, even if the box height is easily attainable.

D) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):

Cyclist Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

1. Plate Loaded Heel Elevated Pistol Squat; 4-6 reps/side @ 30X1 Tempo

- rest 60 sec

2. Plate Loaded Banded Spanish Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Interval Weight Training (15 min):

3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP)

650/520m Bike (Male/Female)

12 Dual KB Rack Squat 53/35# or 35/26#

12 Alternating Dual KB Rack Reverse Lunge 53/35# or 35/26# (6/leg)

- in remaining time:

KB Russian Twists

- rest 2mins between sets

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

- 1) Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
- 2) Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
- 3) Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, April 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:

Deficit Pushup

If you're completing the deficit pushups comfortably within the prescribed rep range, here are a few ways to increase the challenge without adding weight: Slow the lowering phase even more. Add a pause at the top or bottom of each rep. Focus on increasing muscle tension throughout the movement—actively squeeze the pecs at the top and maintain tension through the pecs and triceps as you lower. Small adjustments in control can dramatically increase the stimulus.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

- 1) 90 sec Cardio of Choice
- 2) DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
- 3) Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Engine Hot Start (10-12 min):

Every 3:30 x 2-3 sets at Increasing Pace

2-3 Wall Walks

Bike 300/275m (Male/Female)

20sec Handstand Hold

Bike 300/275m

rest remaining time

Effort Note

Set 1 - Moderate

Set 2 - Moderate to Hard

Set 3 - Hard

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Push Press

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

1. Deficit Pushup; 12-15 @ 30X0 Tempo

- rest 60 sec

2. Dumbbell Full Raise; 12-15 @ 20X0 Tempo

- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Upper Couplets (15 min):

2 Sets

For Time

500/400m Row @ 85% (Male/Female)

-60sec rest-

3 rounds for time:

12 Dumbbell Bench Press 50/35#

40 Double Unders or 60 Single Unders

-90-second rest and then repeat from the beginning for a second set-

Effort Note:

For each set (there are 2), complete the 500m Row, then take a 60-second rest, then complete 3 rounds of the couplet. Upon completion of your 3rd round of the couplet, rest 90 seconds and then go back to the Row for the second set.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side

2) Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side

3) Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, April 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:

Carries For Hypertrophy

Farmer's walks and front rack carries are underrated tools for building muscle. One key driver of hypertrophy is loading muscles in a lengthened position, and carries do exactly that for the upper traps. As you stabilize the load, the traps are held under a long, sustained stretch – and that prolonged tension creates a powerful growth stimulus.

If trap development is a priority for you, consider using lifting straps. Removing grip as the limiting factor allows the traps to fatigue more fully and keeps the focus exactly where we want it.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

3 Sets

1) Mixed Front Rack Overhead Carry; 30m/side; 15m/side

2) Renegade Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Kettlebell Hot Start (10-12 min):

4 Rounds Increasing Effort:

18/15 Calorie Bike (Male/Female)

12 Alternating KB Half Snatch (5/side) 53/35#

12 KB Split Stance Ballistic Row 53/35#

rest 45 sec between rounds

Round 1 - Moderate

Round 2 - Hard

Round 3-4 - Very Tough Pace

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Close Grip Lat Pulldown or Neutral Grip Pull Up

Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 4 @20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Double Drop Set to Failure.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

Loading Note:

If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the double drop set, don't worry about percentages; instead, add back two levels of assistance (or less weight), similar to your first

and second working sets. You will adjust the weight again for your second drop set. Drop sets are performed right after you have adjusted the weight after your set of 4.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

1. Wide Grip Barbell Bent Over Row; 8-10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

- rest 30 sec

2. Farmers Walk; 30m

- rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Aerobic Carry (18 min):

For Time

40-30-20-10 (40-32-24-16-8)

Bike Cals (Male/Female)

12-12-12-12

Burpee No Jump

8-8-8-8/side

Side Plank Rotations

*100 Feet Dual KB Front Rack Carry after each round

*18min Time Cap.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Bottom of Bench Dip Stretch; 30 sec

2) Sidelying Thoracic Rotation w/ Reach; 5/side

3) Tall Kneeling Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):

Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate

Walk 30sec

x 8

4 Sets

- Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10/arm

- 15sec Single Leg Wall Sit/leg
- 15sec Planche Lean
- Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate
- Walk 30sec
- x 8
- 4 Sets
- 15sec Single Arm Reverse Plank Bridge R
- 15sec Single Arm Reverse Plank Bridge L
- 15sec Star Plank R
- 15sec Star Plank L
- Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 60sec Moderate
- Walk 30sec
- x 8

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):

30 min Mobility

1. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
2. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
3. Wrist Circles x 10
4. Downdog to Updog x 5
5. Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 with 5 sec hold.
6. Prone Band Pass Through x 10
7. Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10
8. Crab Reach x 5/side
9. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
10. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side
11. Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 1 min Center
12. Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min
13. Reverse Nordics x 10

Friday, May 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:

Romanian Deadlift Low Rep

Five reps on the Romanian deadlift is relatively low for this movement. The heavier loading helps reinforce strong bracing mechanics and creates a powerful posterior chain stimulus. Because of that demand, execution matters. This week, reps decrease, but tempo slows, making each rep more

difficult. If you're newer to RDLs, keep the load modest – either stay at last week's weight or increase by about 5% to account for the slower tempo. Move well first, then load it.

Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

1) 15 sec Cardio Sprint

2) Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side

3) Barbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15 min):Barbell Warm-up:

1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)

10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift

10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press

10 Overhead Squat

10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold

10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold

10 sec Overhead Squat Hold

+

Every 90-120sec x 5-6 sets

1 Full Snatch @ about 85-90%

- rest until the next :90-120sec

*Perform a few easy ramp up sets if needed. The goal here is lots of quality reps, building up to a decently heavy weight for today.

Sets 1-6: Moderate-Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Romanian Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

1. Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. L Sit on Parallettes; 15-30 sec
- rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Threshold Lower Body (15-18 min):

2 sets:

Row 500/450m (Male/Female)

9 Burpee Box Jump Over (24/20" box)

12 Russian Swing to Goblet Squat 53/35#

21 Sit-Ups

42 Double Unders

21 Sit-Ups

12 Russian Swing to Goblet Squat 53/35#

9 Burpee Box Jump Over (24/20" box)

Row 500/450m

rest 90-120sec

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side

2) Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

3) Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, May 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:

Landmine Meadow Row Technique

The landmine meadows row is a single-arm row variation that uses the landmine setup to challenge the upper back, lats, and rear delts from a different angle. Use a wider elbow path and focus on pulling through the back rather than the arm. The leverage of the landmine helps create a strong contraction while keeping tension consistent throughout the rep.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

- 1) 90 sec cardio of choice
- 2) Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
- 3) Prone Snow Angels; 10 reps
- 4) Band Pullapart; 15 reps

C) Gymnastics Skills (12 min):

Every 3:00 x 4 sets

6 V Ups or Tuck Ups

2 Strict Muscle Up

Row 12/10 Cals (Male/Female)

2 Strict Muscle Up

6 V Ups or Tuck Ups

Effort Note:

Any muscle up variation is acceptable in place of the strict ring muscle up. A regression may be the following:

Strict Ring Muscle Up > Muscle Up > Bar Muscle Up > Band Assisted Muscle Up > Muscle Up Ring Row + Ring Dip

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Barbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

1. Landmine Meadow Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

- rest 30 sec

2. Single Arm DB or Cable Lean Away Lateral Raise;; 12-15 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo

- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning: Week 6 (12 min):

Every 90sec x 8 sets

1st Set - 8-10 Burpee to Plate + 4-8 Supinated Strict Pull Up @ 30X0 Tempo

2nd Set - 8-10 Burpee to Plate + 6-8 Alternating KB Push Press 35/26# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

*Every 90 sec you begin a new set, and it starts with the 1st, then moves to the 2nd. Your 3rd set is a repeat of the 1st.

*Pull Ups - Scale your pull ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side

2) Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

3) Hands Clapsed Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Sunday, May 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

Sunday, May 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

Work in Lesson - Week 6

Equipment won't replace effort, but the right tools can help you get more out of the effort you're already giving.

Straps can let you train your posterior chain without your grip giving out first. Stable shoes can make heavy lifts feel more grounded and controlled. A belt can help you brace better when the load gets serious. None of that is cheating - it's just using tools to support the work.

These aren't shortcuts; they're leverage. And if something helps you train harder, safer, and more consistently, I'm all for it - as long as you're using it with intention and not as a crutch.

That said, the most important accessory you own isn't something you buy. It's consistency.

With love,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, April 27th, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:

Volume and Intensity Progression

Over this six-week progression, reps gradually decrease while weights increase. Some athletes feel more fatigued by higher reps, while others feel it more from heavier loading, so pay attention to how the later weeks affect your body. You might feel energized by fewer reps and heavier weights, or you may notice more fatigue. Neither is right nor wrong – the goal is simply to build awareness of how you respond to different training stress. When the next training block begins, and you return to Week 1, the relationship flips again, bringing you back to higher reps and lighter loads to restart the progression.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

- 1) 90 sec Cardio of Choice
- 2) Split Stance Isometric w/ Pulse; 20-30 sec/side
- 3) Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):

DB Suitcase Cyclist Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

1. Heel Elevated Pistol Squat; 4-6 reps/side @ 30X1 Tempo

- rest 60 sec
- 2. Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):

Every 3:00 x 5 Sets

14 Single Arm DB Turkish Sit Ups 25/10# (7/side) (Male/Female)

14 Switch Lunge (7/side)

14 Hamstring March (7/side) 50/35#

30 Double Unders or 50 Single Unders

Effort Note:

Every 3 minutes, begin a new set. Complete all three movements in the listed order within the 3-minute window. This is performed as a sequence, not separate intervals. Aim to finish the work with approximately 30 seconds remaining in each 3-minute block so you can rest before the next set begins. Adjust your pace as needed to maintain consistent effort across all 5 sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

- 1) Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
- 2) Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
- 3) Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, April 28th, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:

Farmers Walk For Hypertrophy

The farmer's walk is an underrated tool for building muscle. One key to hypertrophy is loading muscles in a lengthened position, and the carry places the upper traps under a long, sustained stretch as they work to stabilize the load. That prolonged tension can create a strong growth stimulus for the traps. If your goal is to emphasize trap development, consider using lifting straps. Reducing grip limitation allows the traps to fatigue more fully and keeps the focus where we want it.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

- 1) 90 sec Cardio of Choice
- 2) DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
- 3) Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

DB Push Press

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets:

1. Dumbbell Bent Over Row; 8-10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Farmers Walk; 30m
- rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (12 min):

Every 3 minutes x 4 Sets

15-20 Pushups

12 Burpees

30m Farmers Walk 70/50#

Effort Note:

Every 3 minutes, you begin a new set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

- 1) Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
- 2) Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
- 3) Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, April 29th, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist Minimalist

A) Active Recovery Work: Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:

30 min Mobility

1. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
2. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
3. Wrist Circles x 10
4. Downdog to Updog x 5
5. Prone Shoulder External Rotation x 5 with 5 sec hold.
6. Prone Band Pass Through x 10
7. Butterfly Stretch Fold x 10
8. Crab Reach x 5/side
9. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
10. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch x 1 min/side
11. Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 1 min Center
12. Reclining Hero Pose x 1 min
13. Reverse Nordics x 10

Thursday, April 30th, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:

Romanian Deadlift Low Rep

Five reps on the Romanian deadlift is relatively low for this movement. The heavier loading helps reinforce strong bracing mechanics and creates a powerful posterior chain stimulus. Because of that demand, execution matters. This week, reps decrease, but tempo slows, making each rep more difficult. If you're newer to RDLs, keep the load modest — either stay at last week's weight or increase by about 5% to account for the slower tempo. Move well first, then load it.

Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

- 1) 15 sec Cardio Sprint
- 2) Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side
- 3) Dumbbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @ 40X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

1. Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo

- rest 60 sec

2. L Sit on Parallettes; 15-30 sec

- rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (12-15 min):

3 Sets

Run 200m

rest 15sec

16 DB Suitcase Walking Lunge 50/35# (Male/Female)

12 Squat Jumps

rest 15sec

Run 200m

rest walk 60-90sec between sets

Effort Note:

Set 1 - Moderate Pace

Set 2 - Hard Pace

Set 3 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side

2) Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

3) Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, May 1st, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:

Meadow Row Technique

The meadows row is a single-arm row variation that challenges the upper back, lats, and rear delts from a different angle than a traditional row. Use a wider elbow path and focus on pulling through the back rather than the arm.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

1) 90 sec cardio of choice

2) Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side

3) Prone Snow Angels; 10 reps

4) Band Pullapart; 15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Single Arm DB Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

1. Single Arm DB Meadow Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

- rest 30 sec

2. DB Lean Away Lateral Raise; 8-10 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo

- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):

Every 90sec x 8 sets

1st Set - 8-10 Burpee + 4-8 Supinated Strict Pullup @ 30X0 Tempo

2nd Set - 8-10 Burpee + 6-8 Alternating DB Push Press 35/25# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

*Every 90 sec you begin a new set, and it starts with the 1st, then moves to the 2nd. Your 3rd set is a repeat of the 1st.

*Pull-Ups - Scale your pull-ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side

2) Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

3) Hands Clapsed Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, May 2nd, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist Minimalist

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work:

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run, Row or Bike

1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%

2mins @ 90%

1:30 @ 80%

1min @ 70%

EMOM x 6mins

Odd - 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side

Even - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Hold

Run, Row or Bike

1min @ 70%

1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20-30sec Half Push Up Isometric
Even - 20sec Chin Over Bar Isometric
Run, Row or Bike
1min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
2mins @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:

Upper Body Mobility

1. Shoulder Circles
2. Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
3. Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
4. Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
5. Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
6. Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
7. Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
8. Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
9. Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
10. Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
11. Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
12. Downdog to Updog x 5

Sunday, May 3rd, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist Minimalist

Work in Lesson - Week 6

Equipment won't replace effort, but the right tools can help you get more out of the effort you're already giving.

Straps can let you train your posterior chain without your grip giving out first. Stable shoes can make heavy lifts feel more grounded and controlled. A belt can help you brace better when the load gets serious. None of that is cheating - it's just using tools to support the work.

These aren't shortcuts; they're leverage. And if something helps you train harder, safer, and more consistently, I'm all for it - as long as you're using it with intention and not as a crutch.

That said, the most important accessory you own isn't something you buy. It's consistency.

With love,
Marcus